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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

My EE is focused on 3 works from the musician Wilbur Soot, the three works being ".Jubilee Line", "I'm Sorry Borris", and "The Fall" from his band Lovejoy. After discussing my initial research question with my supervisor, we came to the conclusion that it needed to be more arguable. We brainstormed some ideas on how to implement more argumentative aspects into my topic, one idea being to compare how Wilbur Soot conceals the message of capitalism on mental health more in his newer and more popular works with the band Lovejoy, compared to how he was more open and insistent in his older works. The next steps I took was to analyze and highlight specific motifs throughout the works, do more outside research, and then work on developing my research question. This was an important topic because the artist is able to engage a social issue that many teenage listeners might not pay attention to when it's presented in the media. But Soot can make it relevant for them, through the artistry and literary value of his lyrics and stylistic techniques. I was confident about my ability to analyze the lyrics and relate them to the message in the songs. I was hesitant at one point about the argumentative aspect of my writing, as there wasn't really a strong counter-argument section, but I worked on improving it thanks to advice from my supervisor. I was really surprised at how well the three songs went together and how much they had in common. I struggled the most with finding evidence that didn't support my argument which relates back to my lack of counter-argument. However, I really enjoyed researching and learning about the topic, especially since it was centered around UK government issues, which is a topic that I don't hear much about as an American. The thing I learned the most about this topic was actually something I wasn't expecting to learn about: the political approach to mental health in Britain. I expected to learn about Wilbur Soot and his experiences with mental health, however, I discovered that his lyrics were often a metaphor for the poor systematic approach that Europe takes toward mental health. As I already was a huge fan of his work, I'm excited to continue to listen to and analyze his future work to see how his perspectives may change in the upcoming years. I learned a lot about how much I enjoy literary analysis, especially the more technical aspects of it. I loved being able to find literary devices and brainstorm about what they mean, what they represent, or what they may be alluding to. This kind of research, coupled with the literary analysis I carried out, will transfer effectively to my university career and beyond, into the working world. I'm really proud of this paper, I put so much work into it and couldn't be happier with the outcome.

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